



The Anti-Procrastination Guide

Stop delaying. Start doing.

Understand why you delay important tasks and build practical habits to take action.



Your checklist to **action.**

Work through one chapter at a time. Tick it off.

- ☐ **01 Why We Procrastinate** It's about feelings, not time.
- ☐ **02 Find Your Pattern** Know your delay style.
- ☐ **03 Make It Clear** Clarity beats motivation.
- ☐ **04 Start Small** Just begin.
- ☐ **05 Plan Your Time** Give every task a place.
- ☐ **06 Remove Distractions** Protect your focus.
- ☐ **07 Build Habits That Stick** Make action automatic.
- ☐ **08 Keep Momentum** Progress over perfect.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE



Read a chapter, then do its “Do it now” task straight away. Action beats reading about action.

Why We Procrastinate

It's about feelings, not time.

The real reasons

- ☐ Fear of failing or being judged.
- ☐ Perfectionism: it has to be flawless.
- ☐ Tasks that feel unclear or too big.
- ☐ Low energy, stress or boredom.

How it feels

- ☐ Relief now, stress later.
- ☐ Guilt that drains your energy.
- ☐ A cycle that keeps repeating.

What actually helps

- ☐ Understand the reason behind the delay.
- ☐ Shrink the task.
- ☐ Build small, steady habits.



DO IT NOW

Name one task you are avoiding. Write why you think you avoid it.

Find Your Pattern

Know your delay style.

Common styles

- ☐ The Perfectionist: waits for the perfect moment.
- ☐ The Overwhelmed: doesn't know where to start.
- ☐ The Deadline Rusher: waits for pressure to build.
- ☐ The Distracted: gets pulled away by the phone.

Spot your excuses

- ☐ "I'll do it later."
- ☐ "I'm not in the mood."
- ☐ "I work better under pressure."
- ☐ "I need more information first."

Track it

- ☐ Note what you avoided and when.
- ☐ Note what you did instead.
- ☐ Look for the pattern after 3 days.



DO IT NOW

Pick your main delay style. Write one example from this week.

Make It Clear

Clarity beats motivation.

Define the task

- ☐ Write exactly what “done” looks like.
- ☐ Break it into steps of 30 minutes or less.
- ☐ Start each step with a verb: call, write, open.

Prioritise

- ☐ Pick your top 3 for today.
- ☐ Important beats urgent.
- ☐ Do the hardest task first if you can.

Set a deadline

- ☐ Choose a date and time.
- ☐ Tell someone about it.
- ☐ Put it in your calendar.



DO IT NOW

Choose one important task. Break it into 3 clear steps.

Start Small

Just begin.

The 5-minute start

- ☐ Set a timer for 5 minutes.
- ☐ Work with no pressure to finish.
- ☐ Keep going if you feel like it.

Lower the barrier

- ☐ Prepare your space the night before.
- ☐ Open the file or tool first.
- ☐ Remove one small obstacle.

If you feel stuck

- ☐ Do the easiest step first.
- ☐ Write a messy first draft.
- ☐ Switch tasks or places for 10 minutes.



DO IT NOW

Pick one avoided task. Work on it for 5 minutes right now.

Plan Your Time

Give every task a place.

Time blocking

- ☐ Give each task a time slot.
- ☐ Protect your best-energy hours.
- ☐ Add short buffers between tasks.

The Pomodoro method

- ☐ 25 minutes of focused work.
- ☐ 5-minute break.
- ☐ Longer break after 4 rounds.

Weekly review

- ☐ Pick a regular weekly time.
- ☐ Check what's done and what's next.
- ☐ Choose 3 priorities for the coming week.



DO IT NOW

Block 2 focus sessions in your calendar for tomorrow.

Remove Distractions

Protect your focus.

Digital

- ☐ Silence notifications.
- ☐ Keep your phone out of reach.
- ☐ Close extra tabs and apps.
- ☐ Use a website blocker if needed.

Physical

- ☐ Clear your desk.
- ☐ Use headphones or a quiet spot.
- ☐ Keep water nearby.

Mental

- ☐ Keep a “parking list” for stray thoughts.
- ☐ Do one thing at a time.
- ☐ Take real breaks away from screens.



DO IT NOW

Put your phone in another room for your next focus session.

Build Habits That Stick

Make action automatic.

Habit basics

- ☐ Attach it to something you already do.
- ☐ Start tiny: 2 minutes is enough.
- ☐ Same time and place every day.

Stay motivated

- ☐ Track your streak.
- ☐ Reward yourself after finishing.
- ☐ Find an accountability partner.

When you slip

- ☐ Don't wait for Monday.
- ☐ Restart with the smallest step.
- ☐ Be kind, not harsh.



DO IT NOW

Choose one 2-minute habit. Attach it to something you already do.

Keep Momentum

Progress over perfect.

Celebrate wins

- ☐ List what you finished each day.
- ☐ Notice how it feels.
- ☐ Share it with someone.

Review weekly

- ☐ What worked? What blocked me?
- ☐ Adjust one thing.
- ☐ Plan the next week.

Look after yourself

- ☐ Sleep, food and movement fuel focus.
- ☐ Rest is part of productivity.
- ☐ If procrastination feels constant or overwhelming, talk to a counsellor or doctor.



DO IT NOW

Write down 3 things you finished this week.

YOUR ACTION PLAN

7 days. 7 actions.

One small action a day builds the habit.

Day 1

Understand

Name the task you avoid and why.

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Day 2

Clarify

Break one task into 3 clear steps.

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Day 3

Start

Do a 5-minute start on that task.

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Day 4

Plan

Block two focus sessions in your calendar.

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Day 5

Focus

Remove distractions and finish one session.

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Day 6

Habit

Attach one 2-minute habit to your routine.

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Day 7

Review

List your wins and adjust one thing.

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REMEMBER



You don't need motivation to start. Starting creates the motivation.

Plan today.

Fill this in before you start. It takes 5 minutes.

Top 3 priorities

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My first small step

Time blocks

Time	Task

Distractions to remove

My reward when done

This guide offers general self-help ideas, not professional advice.